

Checklist:

Remote Team Management Checklist

Foundations

- ☐ Clarify team priorities for the week
- ☐ Make roles, responsibilities, and expectations explicit
- ☐ Define response-time norms for messages and updates
- ☐ Document how decisions, updates, and knowledge should be shared
- ☐ Default to asynchronous communication when possible

Build Trust

- ☐ Hold regular 1:1 check-ins
- ☐ Ask open-ended questions about workload, morale, and concerns
- ☐ Create space for honest feedback
- ☐ Share uncertainty or humanity as a leader when appropriate
- ☐ Watch for signs of disengagement or isolation
- ☐ Avoid making negative assumptions about silence or tone

Strengthen Communication

- ☐ Repeat important information in multiple places when needed
- ☐ Summarize decisions, owners, and next steps in writing
- ☐ Use dedicated threads/channels for project-specific communication
- ☐ Keep a searchable decision log or knowledge base
- ☐ Set clear meeting norms: purpose, format, and follow-up

Create Communication Rhythms

- ☐ Run daily or weekly stand-ups

- ☐ Include what was done, what's next, and blockers
- ☐ Schedule regular all-hands or team updates
- ☐ Record key updates for people who cannot attend
- ☐ Offer office hours or open Q&A time
- ☐ Review and refine communication rhythms regularly

Foster Connection

- ☐ Build rituals for team bonding
- ☐ Celebrate small wins publicly
- ☐ Encourage peer recognition
- ☐ Create casual spaces for non-work conversation
- ☐ Experiment with fun remote traditions or activities
- ☐ Make time for connection, not just task updates

Use In-Person Time Well

- ☐ Prioritize relationship-building over packed agendas
- ☐ Plan shared meals or informal conversations
- ☐ Include low-pressure group activities
- ☐ Leave unstructured time for natural connection

Manager Habits

- ☐ Check for clarity before assuming alignment
- ☐ Overcommunicate rather than undercommunicate
- ☐ Notice who is participating and who is fading into the background
- ☐ Address misunderstandings quickly
- ☐ Reinforce trust, connection, and consistency every week

Quick Self-Review

- ☐ Does everyone know what matters most right now?
- ☐ Does everyone know where to ask questions and find updates?
- ☐ Are people comfortable being honest about problems?
- ☐ Are wins being noticed?
- ☐ Are quieter team members still connected and supported?

